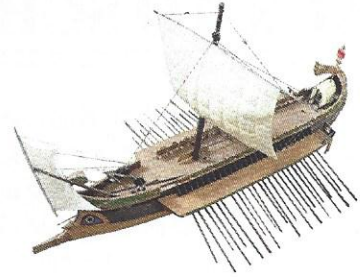


"Ministers of Christ"

Summer 2006

Thank you for your desire to see God's work progress and for the financial resources you are willing to give towards seeing that goal achieved. Sometimes life is not as clean and organized as one would like. Sometimes we have to deal with "stuff." This is especially true dealing with the poor, elderly, and recovering addicts in areas of Tijuana where there are no sewer pipes and no regulated electricity (if any electricity at all). Yet God has sent his servants to fulfill Christ's vision to heal the sick, take care of the dying, return the addict to health, and teach the good news both to children and those in prison.



Kathy and I seek to encourage our team of ministers with your prayers and help. By the way, do you know what the word "minister" means? In 1 Cor. 4:1 the word means "under-rower" —a strange word referring to the 170 rowers on a Greek warship called a Trireme* (above). The power of the ram on the front of the ship was dependent on all those humble under-rowers. The soldiers on top got the glory if the battle was won, but everyone died if the rowers did not do their unseen job. Talk about enforced humility! Being a rower was a lowly job and worse yet, there were three levels of rowers, with the minister at the bottom! Yet all of them rowing together provided the momentum, the direction, and the power for victory.



Aldrich short-term team from MN singing with children near dump

In recent months, we have been greatly encouraged by "ministers" from both sides of the border—the faithful workers who have been doing their part to advance the kingdom. Many of these are the unsung heroes: gathering donations; feeding and caring for the elderly at the Refugio; giving up a Saturday to build an addition to the rehab center; hanging out with kids whose living is made by looking through the dump and showing them the love of Christ; washing laundry, cooking pancake breakfasts; and above all praying for the "victory" through Christ.

A Family Update: In April our Cocker Spaniel had puppies. In August we traveled in different directions. Ian and Anna went to Kanakuk Kamp in MO while Kathy and I visited Indiana (my sister) and Tennessee (Civil War sites). We celebrated our 20th anniversary in Cabo San Lucas.



God bless you all as you quietly and in so many ways give power to God's kingdom movement.

Serving on Christ's Trireme,
Greg and Kathy Saracoff**

*Left: Pastor Salazar in front of his house.
Center: Pastor Chuy w/ donated fans
Right: Laundry at El Refugio piles up fast!
Far right: Ian, Anna, Greg & Kathy Saracoff*



* **Triremes** Greek Τριῆρες describes different types of ancient warships. The early type had three rows of oars on each side, manned with one man per oar. (from www.wikipedia.com)



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BACK TO SCHOOL IN MEXICO



School bells soon will be ringing. This is a time of great need in Mexico. Unlike public schools in the U.S., in Mexico kids must pay a registration fee to go to school and they must buy a uniform and a pair of black dress shoes to attend classes. In addition to the poor children that we work with near the city dump and in Grupo, we're helping the children of the staff at the Home for the Elderly and the Drug Rehab. These staff are dedicated volunteers who live on a very thin salary of less than 50 dollars a week per family--because of this they need help with school expenses and extras like back packs. Some folks have already donated but we are still lacking funds for about 20 children so they can go to school. \$190 can help the kids in elementary school, \$220 for high school and \$350 for the 1 student in college. So if you feel led to donate, these are the needs. *Pray that Jehovah Jirah, our Provider, will bless these families "more than all they could ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within them." (Ephesians 3:20)*



Additions ++++ and - - - Subtractions
ADD TWO! MINUS ONE



Ministry to ministers In addition to our ministries with Pastor Javier in drug rehabilitation and ministering to the elderly with Pastor Chuy Mondragon, we are proud to add **Samuel Cabanillas** to our team. Samuel was the president of the alliance of pastors of Tijuana for four years. His vision is to minister to the pastors of evangelical churches of Tijuana. He left his church pastorship to a member of his family so he could devote full time to this service. We are glad to have him on our team. We've already helped him with a training conference of Tijuana leaders (40 men) and are planning another for 120 pastors and leaders. In September he will hold a retreat for pastors' wives and then one for pastors' children. *Pray God refreshes these families and prepares them to impact Tijuana for Christ!*



Ministry to kids at the city dump Our faithful sister in Christ **Graciela Miranda (Chela)** has been working with those kids living near the city dump. She has two groups. One is at Pastor Chuy Mondragon's church "Camino Vivo" and the other is a new work with those building shacks on the side of the dump in Colonia Carretas. The children in these areas are desperately poor. Their families survive by going through the garbage looking for recyclables and food. They often miss school and doing homework is very hard. Chela and Jorge and others from the mission church are having homework clubs and trying to serve a breakfast to these kids. They teach a Bible club on Saturday mornings. The community leaders in Colonia Carretas have been impressed with Chela's work and have given her two lots so we can build a center to help kids. *Pray for children to break the poverty cycle by getting an education and, most of all, by finding Jesus.*

Leaving Team Tijuana—La Roca Although we've worked together with La Roca for many years, **Pastor Miguel Villanueva** has decided to leave the team, reorganize under the Servants Network mission and bring in new leaders from outside. It is time for Pastor Miguel to retire and he is preparing the ministry for his exit. Since they have left the team, we are limited in how we can help. Any future gifts for La Roca should be given to their mission—Servants Network. This is a time for new direction for La Roca and we wish them well and *ask you to join us in prayer for this transition time, for God's provision and blessing. "May our Lord Jesus Christ himself and God our Father who loved us and by his grace gave us eternal encouragement and good hope, encourage your hearts and strengthen you in every good deed and word."*
2 Thessalonians 2: 16-17